

Learning Systems Strand Policies

Three-Term Calendar

Aspects in the Three-Term Calendar	Before	After
Basic structure of the school year	Four quarters, shorter grading cycles, more frequent transitions	Three terms with Opening Block, Instructional Block, and End-of-Term Block
Instructional time	More fragmented by short cycles, quarterly interruptions, and compressed teaching periods	The calendar is explicitly designed to protect instructional time , reduce transitions, and allow deeper mastery and more manageable pacing
Non-instructional activities	Co-curriculars, celebrations, and teacher activities could spill into teaching time	End-of-Term Blocks now serve as the protected window for co-curriculars, report distribution, INSET, ARAL scheduling, and wellness breaks
Beginning of school year	BOSY activities could be treated as a cluster of administrative tasks	Term 1 now has a formal Opening Block with structured learner readiness, baseline, orientation, and health-related activities
Remediation and ARAL	Often treated as separate interventions or add-ons	The policy embeds structured remediation and ARAL inside instructional and end-of-term structures
Teacher wellness	Often informal or dependent on school practice	The calendar creates protected wellness breaks and explicitly says teachers should not be assigned instructional, administrative, or extracurricular duties during those breaks, except in emergencies

Parent interface

Reporting points depended on old
quarter logic

Progress/Performance Reports are now **distributed by
term**, during parent-teacher conferences scheduled in
the End-of-Term Block

Lesson Planning

Area	Before	After
Nature of lesson planning	Often experienced as documentary compliance, with excessive logs and rigid formats	Lesson planning is repositioned as a practical instructional tool , not a paperwork exercise
Templates and required formats	Multiple local expectations, old DLP/DLL habits, added templates, add-on forms, or school/division preferences	The policy explicitly says schools, divisions, and regions shall not require lesson plan templates, add-on forms, or documentation beyond the prescribed form
Use of lesson plans	Often used as proof of compliance or checked for completeness	Lesson plans are now for intentions, learning experience, assessments, and ways forward , and are meant to reduce unnecessary workload and support learning design better
Teacher autonomy	Teachers often felt they had to follow formats or scripts rigidly	Teachers are explicitly trusted to use professional judgment in structuring the learning experience and adapt based on learner needs and evidence
Collaborative planning	Possible, but not always normalized or protected	The policy encourages co-created lesson plans , LAC-based collaborative planning, and acceptance of shared outputs as valid evidence of preparation
School head role	Mostly monitor whether teachers submitted plans	School heads must provide structured collaboration opportunities, protect ancillary time, manage instructional leadership

		assignments, and keep feedback flowing to the SDO
Use in supervision	Often document-centered and sometimes punitive	The policy says lesson plans should be used as supportive tools for developmental feedback , with short walkthroughs and coaching encouraged
Transition to new format	Abrupt compliance expectations could happen	A one-year transition period is built in; reasonable efforts toward alignment should not be sanctioned during transition
Monitoring	Mostly school- or division-specific habits	School heads are expected to submit brief monthly updates on adoption and challenges under the M&E framework

Classroom Assessment, Grading, Awards, and Recognition

Area	Before	After
Main purpose of assessment	Easily reduced to grading, compliance, and report card production	Assessment is explicitly framed as a core part of teaching that should improve instruction, provide meaningful feedback, and support learner growth
Formative assessment	Present in principle, but uneven in practice	Formative assessment is now central, embedded before, during, and after instruction , using the ESRU cycle and daily evidence to guide teaching
Summative load	Often could become excessive or poorly timed	The policy sets clearer term architecture : minimum and maximum WWs/PTs, two Summative Tests, and one Term Exam where applicable
KS1 grading	Numeric grades and awards could still shape school culture too early	KS1 shifts to descriptive grading , and no academic awards or honors are to be conferred at KS1
KS2–KS4 grading	Legacy weighting and transmutation patterns from earlier policy regime	New subject weights are introduced, including stronger emphasis on performance tasks; SY 2026–2027 uses adjusted transmutation , and SY 2027–2028 shifts to zero-based grading
Use of descriptors	Grades often stood alone	Numeric grades now come with qualitative descriptors such as Advancing,

		Benchmarking, Connecting, Developing, Emerging, each linked to instructional response
Promotion and intervention	Remediation often concentrated at year-end	The policy expects timely remedial interventions , beginning within the term after early summative evidence, with classroom accommodations and school support pathways
Grade validation	Often administrative	School heads are explicitly expected to conduct regular validation of grading practices to uphold accuracy, consistency, and integrity
AI and authenticity	Inconsistent local rules	The policy now distinguishes AI-Prohibited, AI-Limited, and AI-Allowed with Documentation; schools must protect authenticity and equity in assessment
Awards and recognition	More competition-oriented, with ranking culture persisting	Recognition is recalibrated: no KS1 academic awards, Academic Excellence Award only for KS2–4 with overall average 95+ and no failing marks, and recipients listed alphabetically rather than by rank

Flexible Learning Programs

Area	Before	After
Policy frame	Flexible arrangements were often fragmented under older ADM/FLO practice	FLP is now a unified national framework that consolidates prior flexible arrangements inside the formal K-12 system
When flexibility is used	Often ad hoc, modality-specific, or based on local workaround	FLP is intended for learners who cannot consistently participate in regular classroom-based instruction due to context, circumstance, or barriers
School-level instructional design	Could be driven by resource availability alone	Schools must maintain curriculum integrity under FLP, aligned with the revised K-10 curriculum, strengthened SHS curriculum, and the three-term calendar
Modalities	Often talked about in isolation	FLP clarifies accommodations and modalities: schools can use in-person, blended, modular, or online arrangements singly or in combination depending on context
Learner profiling	May have been informal or inconsistent	The policy expects structured learner profiling tools such as the FICS Analysis Tool , ILRT, and Learner Access Survey to inform placement and support

Learning facilitators	Parent/community support may have been informal	FLP formalizes learning facilitators, their scope, limitations, and required Statement of Undertaking; they may include parents, volunteers, RQA personnel, or care-facility staff under school supervision
Teacher workload	FLP roles could become hidden extra work	FLP explicitly says teachers assigned to FLP accommodations should receive equitable workload treatment; OHSS teacher adviser roles are also given specific load credit rules
Safety and inclusion	Flexible arrangements could create uneven quality and protection	FLP requires learning environments to be inclusive, accessible, gender-responsive, and aligned with child protection and online safety measures
Monitoring	May have depended on local forms	Annexes indicate required school responsibilities for learner profiling, implementation readiness, LIS tagging, child protection, and reporting to SDO

Education in Emergencies

Area	Before	After
General approach to disruptions	Often reactive and heavily dependent on class suspension decisions	EiE introduces a levels-based Learning Continuity Framework : HAYO, HINAY, HINGA, HINTO, each with different priorities, learning experiences, and resource expectations
Role of well-being	Often secondary to “keep classes going” pressure	The policy explicitly says well-being is foundational to the capacity to teach and learn; safety, stability, and connection come first
School continuity planning	Plans could be generic or updated inconsistently	Every school must have a Learning and Service Continuity Plan (LSCP) developed annually before the school year and updated every term
Decision-making	Often binary: class or no class	The framework now guides decisions based on level of disruption, teacher/learner well-being, and community context ; school heads may exercise professional judgment in good faith under the policy
Learning materials during disruptions	Could be assembled late or inconsistently	Schools must identify learning experiences and keep resources aligned to LSCP; if the school shifts to Hinay/Hinga/Hinto without prior distribution, a week’s worth of printed materials must be sent before learners go home
Reporting	Often multiple channels and delays	School heads must report the school’s learning

		continuity level through the EiE dashboard within the first 12 hours of disruption, and also report learning experiences/materials used for Hinay, Hinga, or Hinto
Parent engagement	Often limited to information dissemination	Schools must orient parents/guardians to the LSCP at the beginning of the year and may continue follow-up capacity-building on home support and MHPSS
Makeup classes	Often scheduled inconsistently	The policy states makeup classes are required if actual class days fall below 90% of mandatory contact days, and scheduling is left to the discretion of the school head
Longer disruptions	Previously schools might prolong emergency practices indefinitely	The policy says prolonged HINGA or HINTO may require shifting to FLP as an alternative normal
Return to normal	Often assumed as simple resumption	Schools must return gradually to HAYO, with structured remediation and foundational skill recovery, and no rush back to regular pacing that harms well-being or understanding

Strengthened Senior High School

Area	Before	After
Curriculum structure	Legacy SHS with multiple strands and a more fragmented subject architecture	SSHS streamlines SHS into two tracks : Academic Track and Technical-Professional Track; strands are removed to increase learner flexibility and choice
Core subjects	15 core subjects in the old structure	Core subjects are reduced to 5 , delivered in Grade 11 and across the three terms for the whole year
Electives	More strand-bound	Electives are clustered , and learners can choose across clusters based on intended exit and interests, not rigid strand boundaries
Time allotment	Different SHS subject time structure under old design	New time allotments are specified, including 160-hour core subjects, 80–320-hour electives, and extended immersion patterns
Class programming	Old templates and strand assumptions shaped scheduling	The draft explicitly says school heads shall lead in preparing class programs that accommodate all required subjects, including work immersion, and use facilities, resources, and teacher availability efficiently
Teacher development	SHS training could be selective or uneven	School heads, with CO/RO/SDO support , are expected to ensure teachers receive professional development to bridge content and skill gaps, improve differentiation, and use 21st-century approaches; LACs should be used actively for SHS

Area	Before	After
		teacher collaboration
Lesson planning and assessment	SHS implementation could have its own separate instructional habits	SSHS explicitly says lesson planning shall follow the revised lesson planning policy, and classroom assessment shall adhere to the revised assessment policy
Resources	Uneven access and inconsistent school-level resource interpretation	BLR will provide curated teaching and learning resources; schools may use quality-assured supplementary resources
Inclusion and contextualization	Inclusion could be handled as a separate concern	SSHS says the curriculum must be contextualized for SNEd, IPed, and ALS alignment where relevant

SHS Work Immersion, Field Exposure, and Arts Apprenticeship

Area	Before	After
Nature of off-campus experiential learning	Often associated mainly with old work immersion structures	The strengthened model differentiates Work Immersion , Field Exposure , and Arts Apprenticeship , with different roles across tracks and electives
Hours and models	Less integrated with the three-term logic	Work immersion can now range from 320 to 640 hours depending on model, term sequence, learner pathway, and partner capacity; field exposure and arts apprenticeship have their own models and phases
School head role	May have been more supervisory at a distance	The draft assigns school heads clear responsibilities: appoint focal persons and teachers, strengthen partnerships through MOAs, act as legal representative, approve plans/schedules/deployment, allocate funds, and monitor implementation/reporting
Partnerships	Schools could rely on informal or underdeveloped partner arrangements	Formal partnership building is central, with MOAs, industry inspection, training plans, and orientation for parents and industry partners
Learner support while deployed	Monitoring could be light	Weekly Kumustahan mentoring/monitoring sessions are built in to check well-being, progress, and issues during immersion
Grading	Could rely heavily on teacher-side school evaluation	Work immersion and field exposure grading are explicitly weighted toward industry or authentic performance evidence, with portfolios and documented outputs as validation